

Instructional Design Document

THE AI CAREER AGENT: BUILD YOUR
PERSONAL JOB SEARCH BOT

IDOL ACADEMY

DATE: 01/02/2026

Project Context

Purpose of the Course: This training addresses the critical "employability gap" for IDOL Academy students who possess strong technical design skills but struggle to articulate their value in corporate terms. Many candidates fail to pass Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS) due to residual "Teacher-Talk" (e.g., "Lesson Planning" vs. "Curriculum Design") or generic summaries. The purpose of this course is to operationalize the job search by guiding learners to build a custom "AI Career Agent"—a persistent, trained chatbot that acts as their personal recruiter, copywriter, and interview coach.

- **The Problem (The Gap):** Internal data shows IDOL Academy students possess strong technical skills but suffer from an "Employability Gap." They struggle to translate "Teacher-Talk" into corporate language, leading to rejection by Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS).
- **The Solution:** A task-centered workshop that operationalizes the job search. We move beyond theory by guiding learners to build a custom "AI Career Agent"—a persistent tool that acts as their personal recruiter and copywriter.
- **The Narrative Strategy:** To lower anxiety, we reframe the opaque hiring process as a **"Firewall."** The learner is an **"Operative"** building an **"AI Droid"** to penetrate the system. This shifts the focus from personal inadequacy to a gamified technical challenge.

Organization Overview: IDOL Academy is a trade school that helps instructional designers and eLearning developers land their first corporate ID job. The academy focuses on practical, portfolio-based training to bridge the gap between academic theory and corporate application.

Target Audience Profile

- **Who:** IDOL Academy cohorts (Modules 11–12) and Alumni.
- **Demographics:** Transitioning educators and trainers seeking Corporate ID roles.
- **Psychographics:** High motivation but low confidence regarding ATS algorithms; they feel "invisible" in the application pile.

Instructional Architecture (Merrill's First Principles) This course rigorously applies **Merrill's First Principles of Instruction** to ensure a "whole task" progression. We move from simple configuration to complex simulation using a scaffolded approach.

- **Activation:** Learners diagnose their current "Generic" resume failure (Level 1).
- **Demonstration:** Learners watch the "AI Droid" perform the task via screen-capture video (Levels 2, 4, 6).

- **Application:** Learners perform the task themselves with fading support (Levels 3, 5, 7, 9).
- **Integration:** Learners export their "Agent" for real-world use (Level 11).

Project Requirements

COST

Budget: \$0 (Internal Development Resource).

Development Tools: Existing IDOL Academy tech stack (Articulate Storyline/Rise, Canva) and free-tier Generative AI tools (ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude). **Learner Cost:** None. Learners will utilize the free versions of AI models or their own existing subscriptions. **Hosting:** Hosted within the existing IDOL Academy LMS and Mighty Network community.

TIMELINES

Seat Time (Course Duration): 30–40 Minutes.

- **Format:** Asynchronous, self-paced module.
- **Pacing:** Single-sitting completion to minimize drop-off rates.

STANDARDS

Instructional Architecture: The curriculum must rigorously apply **Merrill's Pebble-in-the-Pond model** to structure the learning path, with all performance goals defined using the **ABCD format** (Audience, Behavior, Condition, Degree) to ensure measurability.

Delivery Strategy: Content will utilize **Scenario-Based Learning** to anchor technical skills in realistic narratives, shifting the focus from passive consumption to active problem-solving.

Assessment Protocol: Evaluations must be **Authentic and Performance-Based**, requiring learners to produce tangible deliverables (e.g., actual resume bullets).

Accessibility Standard: Course will be designed to meet WCAG 2.1 AA standards (e.g., closed captions for video, alt-text for images, keyboard navigability for Storyline interactions).

Learning Requirements

- **Target Audience Profile:** Current IDOL Academy cohorts and alumni specifically focused on the "Career Jump" phase (Modules 11–12).
- **Demographics:** Transitioning professionals (e.g., K-12 teachers, corporate trainers, admins) seeking entry-level to mid-level Corporate Instructional Design roles.
- **Skill Gap:** Learners possess instructional design knowledge but lack the specific technical proficiency to leverage Generative AI for personal branding and Applicant Tracking System

(ATS) optimization.

- **Technical & Learning Environment:** The course will be hosted asynchronously on the **IDOL Academy LMS** (Learning Management System) and accessible via the Mighty Networks community links.
- **Delivery Mode:** Self-paced, web-based module (HTML5/SCORM).
- **Hardware/Software Requirements:**
- **Dual-Window Capability:** Learners will need a desktop or laptop to view the course in one window while executing prompts in their AI tool in another (mobile completion is not recommended for this specific technical training).
- **AI Access:** Learners must have active access to a Generative AI tool (OpenAI ChatGPT 3.5+, Claude, or Gemini) prior to starting the module.

Course Objectives

Terminal Learning Objective (TLO): Given access to a Generative AI tool and a target job listing, learners will **construct** a custom AI Job Search Bot to produce tailored professional assets (Resume & LinkedIn Summary) that achieve an **ATS compatibility score of 80% or higher**, and successfully **simulate** a behavioral interview response using the STAR method.

Learning Objectives: By the end of this course, learners will be able to:

1. **Configure (The Persona):** Engineer a multi-variable "Persona Prompt" that prevents AI hallucinations and aligns with L&D industry standards.
2. **Analyze (The Gap):** Identify high-value keywords in a Job Description to conduct a gap analysis against current experience.
3. **Synthesize (The Output):** Construct "XYZ Protocol" prompts (Action + Task + Result) to rewrite resume bullets for maximum impact.
4. **Simulate (The Defense):** Execute a real-time roleplay with the AI agent to practice STAR-method interview responses under time constraints.

Performance Goals:

1. The Creation Goal (Resume & Profile)

Utilize generative AI to translate raw instructional design data into corporate-ready, results-oriented resume bullets and LinkedIn summaries.

2. The Validation Goal (ATS Optimization)

Evaluate and refine application materials against simulated ATS filters to ensure keyword alignment and maximize the probability of passing automated screens.

3. Interview Readiness

Simulate behavioral interviews with a configured AI agent to practice STAR-method responses and increase confidence during recruiter screenings.

Course Outline

“Beat the Bot” Meter Game

Instructional Strategy Overview

Tools & Technology Overview

- **Articulate Rise 360:** To build the main asynchronous lesson modules (responsive, web-based) for rapid development and easy navigation of text-heavy content (like prompts).
- **Articulate Storyline 360:** To create the simulated "chat" interactions where learners practice roleplaying with the AI bot without needing the live tool immediately.
- **Vyond:** To create engaging animated explainer videos that introduce the concepts (like the "Hook-Story-CTA" formula) or to depict "before and after" scenarios of a job seeker's journey, adding a high-quality visual narrative to the training.
- **Canva:** To design the visual assets, including course headers, "Job Aid" cheat sheets, and infographic summaries.
- **Generative AI (ChatGPT / Claude / Gemini):** To generate the course content, write the scenarios, and test the prompts yourself to ensure they work before teaching them.
- **Google Docs / Microsoft Word:** To create the downloadable "Prompt Library" or "Workbook" that learners can save and use offline.
- **Mighty Networks:** To host the "Social Proof" challenges where learners post their "Before vs. After" screenshots for peer feedback.
- **LinkedIn:** To demonstrate the live application of the optimized headlines and summaries in a real-world environment.

Game Premise

The Premise: To address the survey data showing that over 50% of IDOL learners lack confidence in understanding hiring manager expectations, this "Operative" narrative validates their anxiety by reframing the opaque hiring process as a "Firewall" that requires a specialized tool to penetrate rather than just a generic application. By casting the learner as an engineer tasked with building an "AI Droid" to analyze the "Enemy Data" (Job Description), we shift the psychological burden from personal inadequacy to a tangible technical challenge; this empowers learners to stop guessing and start objectively measuring their success via the "Green Zone" metric (85%+), transforming the subjective fear of the unknown into a gamified mission where they utilize AI to translate their actual experience into the precise language hiring managers are looking for.

Goal: Players must optimize a resume to move a visual "Match Meter" from 15% (Red) to 85% (Green) using AI tools.

Container: Articulate Rise 360 with embedded Storyline 360 interactions.

Assessment Strategy

- **Format:** Authentic / Performance-Based.
- **Criteria:** Learners are not graded on multiple-choice questions. They are graded on the **production of tangible deliverables:**
 1. An initialized AI Chat Thread (The Bot).
 2. A rewritten Resume Summary (The Asset).
 3. A self-validated STAR response (The Interview).

UI Visual Concept

- **Header:** "MISSION MANIFEST: OPERATION GREEN ZONE"
- **Visual Style:** Dark mode interface, neon green accents.
- **Interaction:** This could be a static menu slide in Storyline, or an interactive map where levels "unlock" as the learner progresses.

The Mission Manifest

Level / Phase	Mission Protocol	Objective
PHASE 1: INITIALIZATION		
Level 0	The Briefing	Receive Mission Orders & Intel.
Level 1	The Glitch	Run Diagnostic on Generic Inputs.
Level 2	System Upgrade	Install "Persona" Source Code.
Level 3	Equip Phase	Initialize Your AI Agent.
PHASE 2: RECONNAISSANCE		
Level 4	Enemy Intel	Scan Job Description for Keywords.
Level 5	Gap Analysis	Calculate Current Match Score.
PHASE 3: EXECUTION		
Level 6	Weapon Calibration	Learn the "XYZ Protocol" Formula.
Level 7	Target Practice	Rewrite Resume Bullet Points.
Level 8	The Perfect Run	Observe Full Optimization Cycle.
PHASE 4: THE ASSAULT		
Level 9	High Score Challenge	Push Resume Summary to Green Zone (85%).
Level 10	Boss Battle	Survive the Interview Simulation.
Level 11	Extraction	Export Assets & Log Out.

Level 0: The Mission Briefing (Introduction)

- **Game Narrative:** You are an Operative entering the system. The "Firewall" (ATS) blocks 75% of agents. Your goal: Green Zone access.
- **Outcome:** Learner identifies the "Match Score" concept and commits to the goal of bypassing the ATS.
- **Duration:** 3 Minutes
- **Components:**
 - **Video (MP4):** A high-energy motion graphic showing a resume traveling through a digital pipe and getting rejected by a Red Laser scanner.
 - **Audio:** System Voiceover: *"Access Denied. Match Score Critical."*
 - **Storyline Object:** "Accept Mission" Button (Triggers Meter Variable to 15%).

Level 1: The Glitch (Activation)

- **Game Narrative:** Diagnostic Mode. The system detects "Generic Input" errors. Current methods are failing.
- **Outcome:** Learner identifies that generic inputs (without a persona) result in failure (Red Zone).
- **Duration:** 3 Minutes
- **Components (Tech/Media):**
 - **Interactive Slider:** Labeled "Generic Teaching Experience."
 - **Logic/Trigger:** When the learner drags the slider, the Meter needle shakes but refuses to move past 20%.
 - **Visual State:** "Error Message" Pop-up overlay: *"Context Not Found."*

Level 2: System Upgrade (Demonstration 1)

- **Game Narrative:** Installing the Source Code. Watch the "Droid" upgrade from Basic to Expert.
- **Outcome:** Learner observes how the "Golden Prompt" (Persona) instantly changes the AI's output quality.
- **Duration:** 3 Minutes
- **Components (Tech/Media):**
 - **Screen Recording (MP4):** Video showing the ChatGPT interface. The "Golden Prompt" is pasted, and the AI's tone shifts from robotic to professional Career Coach.
 - **Visual Diagram:** A breakdown of the prompt structure.

Level 3: Equip Phase (Application 1)

- **Game Narrative:** Initialize Your Agent. The learner installs the firmware on their own device.
- **Outcome:** Learner configures and deploys the "Persona Prompt" in their own external AI tool.
- **Duration:** 3 Minutes
- **Components (Tech/Media):**
 - **Text Box:** Displays the "Golden Prompt" text.
 - **JavaScript Trigger:** "Copy to Clipboard" button.
 - **Inventory Item:** Source_Code.txt (Icon unlocks in the menu).
 - **Gate:** Checkbox interaction: *"I have initialized my Agent."*

Level 4: Enemy Intel (Demonstration 2)

- **Game Narrative:** Scanning the Target. The Droid analyzes the "Enemy Data" (The Job Description).
- **Outcome:** Learner recognizes that the Job Description (JD) contains the hidden "Answer Key" (Keywords).
- **Duration:** 3 Minutes
- **Components (Tech/Media):**
 - **Animation:** A document labeled "Job Description" is scanned. Keywords (ADDIE, Stakeholder, SME) glow Neon Green.
 - **Animation Path:** The glowing words move from the JD document into the Chatbot window.

Level 5: The Gap Analysis (Application 2)

- **Game Narrative:** Run Diagnostic. The learner measures their current distance from the target.
- **Outcome:** Learner generates a "Baseline Score" using their AI Agent.
- **Duration:** 3 Minutes
- **Components (Tech/Media):**
 - **Downloadable Asset:** "Target_Job_Description.pdf" (Mock JD).
 - **Text Entry Field:** "Enter your current Match Score % here."
 - **Logic:** If they enter <50, the Meter stays Red. If >50, it moves to Yellow.

Level 6: Weapon Calibration (Demonstration 3)

- **Game Narrative:** The XYZ Protocol. Calibrating the ammunition (Bullet Points) for maximum impact.
- **Outcome:** Learner observes the "XYZ Formula" transforming a weak bullet into a strong one.
- **Duration:** 3 Minutes
- **Components (Tech/Media):**
 - **Lightbox Slide (Pop-up):** The "XYZ Cheat Sheet" appears on screen.
 - **Compare/Contrast:** Two text boxes side-by-side.
 - *Left:* "Managed training." (Red X).
 - *Right:* "Managed training for 50 users resulting in 10% growth." (Green Check).

Level 7: Target Practice (Application 3)

- **Game Narrative:** Sector Clearance. The learner must fix a broken data sector (Bullet Point).
- **Outcome:** Learner rewrites a weak resume bullet using the XYZ formula and validates it.
- **Duration:** 4 Minutes
- **Components (Tech/Media):**
 - **Input Field:** "Paste your optimized XYZ bullet here."
 - **Inventory Item:** XYZ_Protocol_Card.pdf (Icon unlocks).
 - **Self-Check Button:** "Does your bullet have a Number/Metric?" (Yes/No).
 - **Meter Animation:** Meter moves to 60% (Yellow High).

Level 8: The Perfect Run (Final Demonstration)

- **Game Narrative:** Simulation Playback. Watching a master operative clear the Green Zone in record time.
- **Outcome:** Learner visualizes the full workflow (JD $\rightarrow$ Scan $\rightarrow$ Rewrite $\rightarrow$ Apply).
- **Duration:** 2 Minutes
- **Components (Tech/Media):**
 - **Video Montage (Fast Forward):** A 60-second accelerated clip showing the entire process resulting in an "Interview Request" notification.
 - **Audio:** Upbeat, high-tempo "heist" music.

Level 9: High Score Challenge (Application 4 - Guided)

- **Game Narrative:** The Gauntlet. Push the Meter to 100%.
- **Outcome:** Learner optimizes a Professional Summary to achieve an 85%+ Match Score.
- **Duration:** 5 Minutes
- **Components (Tech/Media):**
 - **Downloadable Asset:** "Messy_Teacher_Resume.docx".
 - **Timer:** 5:00 Minute Countdown Clock.
 - **Slider Interaction:** "Slide to your final score."
 - **Trigger:** If Slider > 85, Meter animates to **GREEN ZONE** with "Success" sound effect.

Level 10: The Boss Battle (Final Application - Unguided)

- **Game Narrative:** The Final Gatekeeper. The resume worked, now you must survive the Interview.

- **Outcome:** Learners will defeat the "Final Boss" (The Interview) by utilizing their AI Agent to simulate a behavioral question and delivering a structured **STAR response** under a **2-minute time limit**.
- **Duration:** 8 Minutes
- **Components (Tech/Media):**
 - **Visual Interface:** "Incoming Call" (Boss Battle Mode). Darker background, intense music.
 - **Interaction (The Attack):** "Generate Threat" Button. (Learner prompts AI: *"Ask me a behavioral question about SMEs."*)
 - **Timer (The Pressure):** A large, Red **2:00 Minute Countdown** starts immediately.
 - **Inventory Item:** STAR_Combat_Manual.pdf (Icon unlocks).
 - **Self-Validation (The Defense):**
 - *Learner Prompt to AI:* "Grade me Pass/Fail on STAR structure."
 - *Storyline Input:* Checkbox: "The Bot gave me a PASS."
 - **Result:** If checked, "Boss Defeated" animation plays.

Level 11: The Extraction (Real World Application)

- **Game Narrative:** System Export. You are leaving the simulation. Take your Agent with you.
- **Outcome:** By the end of this session, players will engineer a persistent AI 'Career Agent' to hack the hiring algorithm—transforming raw experience into a 'Green Zone' (85%+) ATS-optimized resume—and successfully defeat the 'Final Boss' (The Interview) by running a real-time behavioral simulation.
- **Duration:** 3 Minutes
- **Components (Tech/Media):**
 - **Visual:** "Access Granted" / "System Log Out" screen.
 - **Download Button:** "Download Loot Bag" (Zip file of all PDFs: Source Code, XYZ Card, STAR Manual, Keyword Bank).
 - **Exit Ticket (Commitment):** Text Entry Field: *"Paste the link to your saved ChatGPT 'Career Agent' chat here to confirm it is persistent."*
 - **Final Audio:** *"Operative, you are cleared for the field. Good luck."*

OTHER MATERIALS

[Learning Materials]



The Inventory List (Learning Materials)

These are the 4 "Unlockable Items" players collect during the game.

1. **Job Aid #1: The Source Code (Text File)**
 - *Game Function:* The "Persona Prompt" used to upgrade the AI.
 - *Format:* .txt file (Simulates a code script).
2. **Job Aid #2: The XYZ Protocol (Cheat Sheet)**
 - *Game Function:* A formula card for rewriting bullet points.
 - *Format:* .pdf (Single page, landscape, graphic-heavy).
3. **Job Aid #3: The Booster Data Bank (Keyword List)**
 - *Game Function:* A dictionary of high-value ID keywords to pass the ATS scan.
 - *Format:* .pdf (Two-column list, "Dictionary" style).
4. **Job Aid #4: The S.T.A.R. Combat Manual (Infographic)**
 - *Game Function:* A tactical guide for the final interview boss battle.
 - *Format:* .pdf (Vertical "Tactical" layout).

Project Sign-Off

Printed Name

Role

Signature

Printed Name

Role

Signature

Printed Name

Role

Signature